
RAN XU

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Address: 2000 N Shoreline Blvd, Mountain View, CA 94043, USA

EDUCATION

Laney Graduate School, Emory University **Atlanta, GA, USA**
Ph.D. in Computational Science and Informatics *Aug. 2021 - Feb. 2026*

- Ph.D. Advisors: [Dr. Carl Yang](#) and [Dr. Joyce Ho](#);
- **Research Interest:** Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models, Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Agents, Data Synthesis with applications in healthcare.

Department of Computer Science and Mathematics, Emory University **Atlanta, GA, USA**
B.S. in Computer Science; B.S. in Applied Mathematics *Aug. 2017 - May 2021*

- GPA: 3.97/4.00;
- Research Assistant advised by [Dr. Jinho Choi](#) on early detection of Alzheimer's Disease from patients' speech recordings.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Coding Agent Team, Google DeepMind GenAI **Mountain View, CA, USA**
Research Scientist *Mar. 2026 - Present*

Search Intelligence Team, Google DeepMind GenAI **Mountain View, CA, USA**
Research Intern *Jun. 2025 - Nov. 2025*

Hosts: [Jingjing Chen](#), [Yu Wu](#), Co-host: [Jiayu Ye](#), Manager: [Hongkun Yu](#)

- **Project:** Training Agentic LLM Judges with Tool-augmented Reinforcement Learning
- **Paper:** One conference paper in [ICLR 2026](#) conference.

AI Lab, Tencent America **Bellevue, WA, USA**
Artificial General Intelligence Research Intern *Feb. 2025 - May 2025*

Hosts: [Kaixin Ma](#), [Wenhao Yu](#), Co-host: [Hongming Zhang](#), Manager: [Dong Yu](#)

- **Project:** Tutorial-augmented VLM-based GUI Agent
- **Paper:** One conference paper in [EMNLP 2025](#) main conference.

Query Understanding Team, Amazon **Palo Alto, CA, USA**
Applied Scientist Intern, Mentor: [Hui Liu](#) Manager: [Qi He](#) *May. 2024 - Oct. 2024*

- **Project:** LLM Self-training for retrieval-augmented generation
- **Paper:** One conference paper in [NAACL 2025](#) main conference.

Meta Platforms, Inc. (formerly named Facebook, Inc.) **Menlo Park, CA, USA**
Enterprise Engineer Intern, Mentor: [Zexi Zhang](#) *May. 2020 - Aug. 2020*

- **Project:** Implemented a procurement platform from both front- and back-end for communication between employees and suppliers.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

(The google scholar link can be found [here](#), * stands for equal contribution)

1. **Ran Xu***, **Tianci Liu***, **Zihan Dong**, **Tony Yu**, **Ilgee Hong**, **Carl Yang**, **Linjun Zhang**, **Tuo Zhao**, **Haoyu Wang**. “[Alternating Reinforcement Learning for Rubric-Based Reward Modeling in Non-Verifiable LLM Post-Training](#)”, Under Review, 2026.
2. **Tianci Liu***, **Ran Xu***, **Tony Yu**, **Ilgee Hong**, **Carl Yang**, **Tuo Zhao**, **Haoyu Wang**. “[OpenRubrics: Towards Scalable Synthetic Rubric Generation for Reward Modeling and LLM Alignment](#)”, Under Review, 2025.
3. **Ran Xu**, **Yuchen Zhuang**, **Yue Yu**, **Haoyu Wang**, **Wenqi Shi**, **Carl Yang**. “[RAG in the Wild: On the \(In\)effectiveness of LLMs with Mixture-of-Knowledge Retrieval Augmentation](#)”, Under Review, 2025.
4. **Ran Xu**, **Yuchen Zhuang**, **Yishan Zhong**, **Yue Yu**, **Xiangru Tang**, **Hang Wu**, **May D. Wang**, **Peifeng Ruan**, **Donghan Yang**, **Tao Wang**, **Guanghua Xiao**, **Carl Yang**, **Yang Xie**, **Wenqi Shi**. “[MedAgentGym: A Scalable Agentic Training Environment for Code-Centric Reasoning in Biomedical Data Science](#)”. In *Proceedings of the Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026. **Oral**.
5. **Ran Xu**, **Jingjing Chen**, **Jiayu Ye**, **Yu Wu**, **Jun Yan**, **Carl Yang**, **Hongkun Yu**. “[Incentivizing Agentic Reasoning in LLM Judges via Tool-Integrated Reinforcement Learning](#)”, In *Proceedings of the Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026.

6. Meng Lu*, **Ran Xu***, Yi Fang, Wenxuan Zhang, Yue Yu, Gaurav Srivastava, Yuchen Zhuang, Mohamed elhoseiny, Charles Fleming, Carl Yang, Zhengzhong Tu, Guanghua Xiao, Yang Xie, Hanrui Wang, Di Jin, Wenqi Shi, Xuan Wang. “[Scaling Agentic Reinforcement Learning for Tool-Integrated Reasoning in VLMs](#)”, In *Proceedings of the IEEE Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2026.
7. **Ran Xu**, Yuchen Zhuang, Zihan Dong, Ruiyu Wang, Yue Yu, Joyce C. Ho, Linjun Zhang, Haoyu Wang, Wenqi Shi, Carl Yang. “[AceSearcher: Bootstrapping Reasoning and Search for LLMs via Reinforced Self-Play](#)”, In *Proceedings of the Thirty-Ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2025. **Spotlight**.
8. **Ran Xu**, Kaixin Ma, Wenhao Yu, Hongming Zhang, Joyce C. Ho, Carl Yang, Dong Yu. “[Retrieval-augmented GUI Agents with Generative Guidelines](#)”, In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2025.
9. **Ran Xu**, Wenqi Shi, Yuchen Zhuang, Yue Yu, Joyce C. Ho, Haoyu Wang, Carl Yang. “[Collab-RAG: Boosting Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Complex Question Answering via White-Box and Black-Box LLM Collaboration](#)”, In *Proceedings of the 2nd Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*, 2025.
10. **Ran Xu**, Hui Liu, Sreyashi Nag, Zhenwei Dai, Yaochen Xie, Xianfeng Tang, Chen Luo, Yang Li, Joyce C Ho, Carl Yang, Qi He. “[SimRAG: Self-Improving Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Adapting Large Language Models to Specialized Domains](#)”, In *Proceedings of North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL)*, 2025. **Oral**.
11. **Ran Xu***, Wenqi Shi*, Yue Yu*, Yuchen Zhuang, Yanqiao Zhu, May D Wang, Joyce C Ho, Chao Zhang, Carl Yang. “[BMRetriever: Tuning large language models as better biomedical text retrievers](#)”, In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2024.
12. Wenqi Shi*, **Ran Xu***, Yuchen Zhuang, Yue Yu, Jieyu Zhang, Hang Wu, Yuanda Zhu, Joyce Ho, Carl Yang, May D Wang. “[EHRAgent: Code Empowers Large Language Models for Complex Tabular Reasoning on Electronic Health Records](#)”, In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2024.
13. **Ran Xu***, Wenqi Shi*, Yue Yu, Yuchen Zhuang, Bowen Jin, May D Wang, Joyce C Ho, Carl Yang. “[RAM-EHR: Retrieval Augmentation Meets Clinical Predictions on Electronic Health Records](#)”, In *Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2024. **Oral**.
14. **Ran Xu**, Hejie Cui, Yue Yu, Xuan Kan, Wenqi Shi, Yuchen Zhuang, Wei Jin, Joyce Ho, Carl Yang. “[Knowledge-Infused Prompting Improves Clinical Text Generation with Large Language Models](#)”, In *Findings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Findings)*, 2024.
15. **Ran Xu**, Yue Yu, Chao Zhang, Mohammed K Ali, Joyce C Ho, and Carl Yang. “[Counterfactual and Factual Reasoning over Hypergraphs for Interpretable Clinical Predictions on EHR](#)”. In *Proceedings of the 2nd Machine Learning for Health symposium (ML4H)*, 2022. **Best Paper Award**.

HONORS AND AWARDS

• NeurIPS 2025 Scholar Reward	2025
• Emory Global Diabetes Research Center Fellowship	2024
• Best Reviewer in KDD 2024	2024
• Best Paper Award at Machine Learning for Health 2022 (Top 2)	Nov. 2022
• Women in Natural Sciences Fellowship	Fall 2021
• The Chair’s Award for Achievements (Top 1)	2020, 2021
• Highest Honor in Honor thesis	Spring 2021
• Dean’s List	Fall 2017, Spring 2018, Fall 2018, Spring 2019

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

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- Programming language: Python, Java, MATLAB, Latex.
 - Deep learning frameworks: Pytorch, Keras.

SERVICES

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- **Teaching Experience:**
 Teaching Assistant for CS570: Data Mining. Spring 2023, Spring 2022
 Teaching Assistant for CS253: Data Structures and Algorithms. Spring 2021, Fall 2021
 - **Guest Lecture:**
 BINF 4008: Advanced ML for Health and Medicine at Columbia University Spring 2026
 - **Conference and Journal Review:** ICML 2026, 2025, 2024, ICLR 2026, 2025, 2024; NeurIPS 2025, 2024, 2023; COLM 2025, 2024; MLHC 2024, 2023; CHIL 2024, 2023; LoG 2023; KDD 2024, 2023, 2022; WWW 2023, 2022; AMIA 2023; ACM TIST 2024; TBD 2022; TKDE 2021; ACL Rolling Reviews (bimonthly since Feb 2024).